

D450

Community Health and Population-Focused Nursing

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A community health nurse at a county fair that draws 10,000 visitors each summer offers free blood pressure screenings to adults with no known heart disease. The booth is sponsored by a local credit union. Which level of prevention is this?

- A. Tertiary prevention
- B. Health promotion only, not prevention
- C. Primary prevention
- D. Secondary prevention

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity is tertiary prevention?

- A. Colon cancer screening
- B. A cardiac rehabilitation program after a heart attack
- C. School nutrition classes
- D. Flu vaccination clinics

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A town has 20,000 residents free of a disease on January 1. The town's mayor is running for re-election. During the year, 50 new cases are diagnosed; the health department also tracks 150 people who already had the disease before January 1. What is the incidence rate per 1,000 at-risk residents?

- A. 2.5 per 1,000
- B. 7.5 per 1,000
- C. 10 per 1,000
- D. 400 per 1,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A new drug keeps people with a chronic disease alive much longer but does not cure it. The rate of new cases stays the same. What happens to prevalence?

- A.** It stays the same, because incidence did not change.
- B.** It rises, because people live longer with the disease.
- C.** It drops to zero over time.
- D.** It falls, because the treatment works.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

After heavy spring rains in a county known for its apple orchards, standing water collects in old tires behind an auto shop and a mosquito-borne illness spreads. Several residents are not using insect repellent. Which part of the epidemiologic triad does the standing water represent?

- A.** Host
- B.** Vector only, outside the triad
- C.** Agent
- D.** Environment

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a measles outbreak, which factor is a host factor?

- A.** The measles virus
- B.** A child's vaccination status
- C.** Crowded classrooms
- D.** Poor ventilation in a daycare

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A county health department, whose director was hired last year, runs a full-scale mass-casualty drill with the hospital and fire department. No disaster is happening. Which phase of disaster management is this?

- A. Response
- B. Recovery
- C. Preparedness
- D. Mitigation only; drills are not part of preparedness

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A clinic that recently repainted its waiting room has funding for a diabetes class. Patients in one neighborhood lack transportation and speak mostly Spanish. Which plan best reflects health equity?

- A. Offer the class in Spanish in that neighborhood and provide transportation.
- B. Give every patient the same pamphlet.
- C. Skip that neighborhood because attendance will be low.
- D. Offer the same English class at the clinic to everyone.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A community health nurse, who grew up in a nearby town, drives slowly through a neighborhood noting boarded-up houses, a lack of grocery stores, and several liquor stores. It is a sunny Saturday afternoon. What kind of data is this?

- A. Primary data from a windshield survey
- B. Secondary data
- C. Subjective data from residents
- D. Not valid data because it is not a survey form

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is an example of secondary data in a community assessment?

- A.** Interviews with local church leaders
- B.** The nurse's windshield survey notes
- C.** A focus group the nurse runs with parents
- D.** County census data on income and housing

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A school nurse, who coaches the debate team, learns that a student's rash has been confirmed as measles. The parents ask that no one be told because the family is traveling next week. What must the nurse do?

- A.** Wait for the lab to report and do nothing.
- B.** Keep it private because the parents asked.
- C.** Report the case to the local health department as required by law.
- D.** Tell the family to delay their trip and take no other action.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A city with 60 opioid overdose deaths last year plans to hand out naloxone kits and open a syringe services program. A council member who owns a restaurant says this will encourage drug use. Which statement reflects the evidence?

- A.** The count of 60 deaths shows the city should wait for more data.
- B.** Such programs work only if people stop using first.
- C.** These programs reduce overdose deaths and infection without increasing drug use.
- D.** They always increase drug use in the community.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A community health nurse at a county fair ~~that draws 10,000 visitors each summer~~ offers free blood pressure screenings to adults with no known heart disease. ~~The booth is sponsored by a local credit union.~~ Which level of prevention is this?

Target word: level of prevention **Decides:** Screening finds existing disease early.

A	Inverted operation	Tertiary manages established disease to limit damage.
B	Adjacent category	Screening is a defined level of prevention.
C	Confusion set	Primary prevention stops disease before it exists; screening looks for disease already present.
D	Correct	Screening detects disease early, before complications.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Which activity is tertiary prevention?

Target word: reverse: find the tertiary example **Decides:** Tertiary limits disability in existing disease.

A	Confusion set	Secondary prevention.
B	Correct	It reduces further damage and restores function.
C	Adjacent category	Primary prevention through education.
D	Inverted operation	Primary prevention.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A town has 20,000 residents free of a disease on January 1. ~~The town's mayor is running for re-election.~~ During the year, 50 new cases are diagnosed; the health department also tracks 150 people who already had the disease before January 1. What is the incidence rate per 1,000 at-risk residents?

Target word: incidence per 1,000 **Decides:** Only new cases over the at-risk population.

A	Correct	$50 \div 20,000 \times 1,000 = 2.5$.
B	Wrong stem number	Uses the 150 existing cases.
C	Confusion set	Adds old and new cases (200), which mixes in prevalence.
D	Inverted operation	Divides population by cases.

4. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

A new drug keeps people with a chronic disease alive much longer but does not cure it. The rate of new cases stays the same. What happens to prevalence?

Target word: reverse: effect on prevalence **Decides:** Prevalence $\approx$ incidence $\times$ duration.

A	Confusion set	Incidence is steady, but duration grew.
B	Correct	More existing cases accumulate at any point in time.
C	Absolute language	No cure means cases remain.
D	Inverted operation	Longer survival without cure increases existing cases.

5. Answer D Concept 3

After heavy spring rains in a county known for its apple orchards, standing water collects in old tires behind an auto shop and a mosquito-borne illness spreads. Several residents are not using insect repellent. Which part of the epidemiologic triad does the standing water represent?

Target word: classify standing water **Decides:** Outside conditions that bring agent and host together.

A	Inverted operation	Host factors are traits of the person, such as repellent use.
B	Adjacent category	Vectors and breeding sites are part of the environment in the triad.
C	Confusion set	The agent is the virus or organism itself.
D	Correct	Standing water is an outside condition that lets the vector breed.

6. Answer B Concept 3 · transfer

In a measles outbreak, which factor is a host factor?

Target word: reverse: find the host factor **Decides:** Host = traits of the person.

A	Adjacent category	That is the agent.
B	Correct	Immunity belongs to the person.
C	Inverted operation	An environmental condition.
D	Confusion set	Also environmental.

7. Answer C Concept 4

A county health department, whose director was hired last year, runs a full-scale mass-casualty drill with the hospital and fire department. No disaster is happening. Which phase of disaster management is this?

Target word: phase **Decides:** Drills happen before an event.

A	Inverted operation	Response happens during an actual event.
B	Adjacent category	Recovery rebuilds after an event.
C	Correct	Planning and drills get ready for a future event.
D	Absolute language	Drills are a core preparedness activity.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A clinic that recently repainted its waiting room has funding for a diabetes class. Patients in one neighborhood lack transportation and speak mostly Spanish. Which plan best reflects health equity?

Target word: equity choice **Decides:** Resources matched to different needs.

A	Correct	Removes the specific barriers so outcomes can be equal.
B	Adjacent category	Equality of resources, not equity.
C	Inverted operation	Widens the gap instead of closing it.
D	Confusion set	Equal access on paper, but it ignores the barriers.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A community health nurse, ~~who grew up in a nearby town,~~ drives slowly through a neighborhood noting boarded-up houses, a lack of grocery stores, and several liquor stores. ~~It is a sunny Saturday afternoon.~~ What kind of data is this?

Target word: type of data **Decides:** Nurse-collected observation.

A	Correct	The nurse is collecting firsthand observations.
B	Inverted operation	Secondary data already exists, like census reports.
C	Adjacent category	No residents were interviewed.
D	Absolute language	Windshield surveys are a standard assessment tool.

10. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

Which is an example of secondary data in a community assessment?

Target word: reverse: find secondary data **Decides:** Already collected by someone else.

A	Adjacent category	Key-informant interviews are primary.
B	Confusion set	Primary observation.
C	Inverted operation	Primary data collected by the nurse.
D	Correct	Existing data compiled by others.

11. Answer C Concept 7

A school nurse, ~~who coaches the debate team,~~ learns that a student's rash has been confirmed as measles. The parents ask that no one be told ~~because the family is traveling next week.~~ What must the nurse do?

Target word: reporting duty **Decides:** Measles is a notifiable disease.

A	Dropped element	Drops the nurse's own reporting duty.
B	Absolute language	Legal reporting duties override the request.
C	Correct	Reporting notifiable diseases does not require consent.
D	Camouflage	Responds to the travel detail but skips the required report.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A city with 60 opioid overdose deaths last year plans to hand out naloxone kits and open a syringe services program. ~~A council member who owns a restaurant~~ says this will encourage drug use. Which statement reflects the evidence?

Target word: harm reduction principle **Decides:** Harm reduction reduces deaths and disease without requiring abstinence.

A	Wrong stem number	The number does not change the evidence on harm reduction.
B	Adjacent category	Requiring abstinence first is the opposite approach.
C	Correct	Harm reduction meets people where they are.
D	Absolute language	Evidence does not show increased use.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	10	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	1	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Levels of prevention	Primary prevention stops disease before it starts (vaccines, education); secondary finds it early (screening); tertiary limits damage from existing disease (rehabilitation).	Calling screening primary prevention because it happens before symptoms.	An intervention and a question about which level it is.
2	Incidence vs. prevalence	Incidence counts new cases in a period among people at risk; prevalence counts all existing cases at a point in time. Longer survival without cure raises prevalence.	Adding old cases into incidence or thinking better treatment lowers prevalence.	“New cases” versus “people living with” a condition.
3	Epidemiologic triad	Disease results from the interaction of agent (the cause), host (the person’s traits), and environment (outside conditions that bring them together).	Labeling a host trait, such as vaccination status, as an environmental factor.	A factor to classify in an outbreak story.
4	Disaster management phases	Preparedness (plans, drills, supplies) comes before an event; response happens during it; recovery restores the community after; mitigation reduces future impact.	Calling a drill part of the response phase.	A disaster-related activity and the timing of it.
5	Health equity vs. equality	Equality gives everyone the same resources; equity gives resources according to need so everyone can reach the same outcome.	Treating equal distribution as the fair solution for groups with unequal needs.	Two groups with different barriers and a choice of how to allocate help.
6	Community assessment data sources	Primary data is collected directly by the nurse (windshield survey, interviews, focus groups); secondary data already exists (census, vital statistics, health department reports).	Calling census tables primary data because they are official.	How the information was gathered.
7	Reportable disease duty	Nurses must report notifiable diseases (such as measles or tuberculosis) to the local or state health department as required by law; patient consent is not required for this report.	Waiting for patient permission or assuming the lab will always report.	A confirmed notifiable disease and a question about who to tell.
8	Harm reduction	Harm reduction lowers the damage from substance use without requiring abstinence first, for example naloxone distribution and syringe services programs.	Believing these programs encourage drug use or should require sobriety first.	A community program for people who use drugs.

Course scope (public description): Community health and population focused nursing concentrates on the theory and concepts of community, public and global health nursing that impact diverse communities. Students learn the role of the community health nurse, learn to assess the community's healthcare needs, available resources, epidemiology, substance abuse, disaster management, and how social determinants of health impact community and public health risk and outcomes. A variety of populations and settings are used in the experiential learning components of this course. Co-requisite: D449